



DIONYSIA

— FOUNDING CREATOR PACK —

For Toby.

— PREPARED, BY HAND, ON THE EVENING OF MAY 14, 2026 —

Toby — the way you describe yourself in the opening line of your profile, "Filmmaker, Michelin-Star Data Chef, AI Creative," is itself the signal that earns a serious conversation. Most filmmakers in this medium pick one register and stay in it. Naming filmmaking, data craft, precision (the Michelin-Star tier matters here — it is a discipline word, not a vanity word), and AI on the same line means you understand something most of the medium has not learned yet: that the new tools demand a craft discipline imported from somewhere else, and that the place to import it from is whatever you actually trained in first.

What follows is the substantive long-form version of what DIONYSIA is, what the founding circle is being assembled around, and what your decision would actually be deciding on, if this turns out to be the room you'd want your work in. It is being sent ahead of any larger commitment — read it the way you'd read a director's bible and a technical spec at once, since the document was written for someone whose attention moves between both registers.

Anything that lands wrong, anything missing, anything you would say differently — write back. The room is being built with care, not pitched at people.

I. WELCOME

DIONYSIA is not another upload feed and it is not a curated showcase that pretends to be a platform. It is the beginning of a permanent institution: a global home for serious cinema made in a new medium, built to outlast a hundred trend cycles and to scale, deliberately, into one of the cultural surfaces this medium will be defined by.

The first chapter is being built with a founding circle of filmmakers whose craft long predates the current AI moment — people who have already built studios, schools, careers, and bodies of work, and who can tell the difference between a generated frame and a directed one. You are being considered for that circle. Not as an early user of a product, and not as a name on a launch list. As one of the architects of the institution itself, if you decide it is the room you want your work in.

Your arc is one of the rarest combinations in the founding circle. CEO and founder of XO Link, co-founder of AION Voice, working specialist in volumetric capture — meaning you are not only directing in this medium but actively building the production and voice infrastructure under it. A University of Winchester training underneath the practice. And London as the British-Anglophone European anchor of a circle that already runs through Paris, Montreal, New York, Jakarta, and Panama. The Michelin-Star Data Chef line in your headline is the rarest tell — a filmmaker who treats data with the discipline of fine kitchen craft, applying precision to a medium that is still arguing over basic technique. That triple register — film, voice synthesis, volumetric capture — applied with the same hand and the same craft discipline, is exactly the kind of integrated profile this platform's wall is being built to honor.

Everything DIONYSIA will mean in five years gets shaped by the work this founding circle puts on the wall in this first chapter — and by the standard you, collectively, decide is the standard. The point of this document isn't to ask you to agree with every word. It's to make sure you know exactly what you would be joining, before you decide whether to join it.

II. THE FOUNDING CHARTER

Every platform pretends to have values. Most discover them under pressure and rewrite them quietly. DIONYSIA's charter is fixed, in writing, before the doors open. It is the rail every editorial, product, and infrastructure decision will pass through — at this size, and at every size after.

— WE BELIEVE —

- *that AI is a medium, the way 16mm or DV is a medium — not a subject, not a genre, and never the noun in our sentences.*
- *that the films are directed, not summoned. A tool can render a frame. Only a filmmaker can intend one.*
- *that emotional resonance is the only criterion that matters. Audiences will always forgive imperfect images. They never forgive emotional disconnection.*
- *that a serious work deserves to land in a place where serious people will actually watch it — credits, breath, silence, and all.*
- *that curation is care, not gatekeeping. A "no" with a reason is more respectful than an algorithm's indifference.*
- *that the filmmakers who built the first chapter should be honored as such — economically, editorially, and culturally — for as long as the platform exists.*

— WE REJECT —

- *the contextual collapse of feeds — where a year of work shares a scroll with an "animals dancing" clip and authorship quietly disappears.*
- *the slot machine of unmoderated upload, the cynicism of "creator-owned" as marketing copy without real ownership, and any phrase that uses the word "content" to describe a film.*
- *open submissions without an editorial wall. Submission is not publication.*
- *algorithmic for-you feeds, where popularity becomes a substitute for taste and curation disappears into noise. Discovery on DIONYSIA stays editorially intentional — at this catalog size, and at every size after.*

— any framing — internal or external — that treats founding filmmakers as a stepping stone, a stage, or an audience to be replaced. You are not the rollout. You are the institution.

III. YOUR ROLE

The honest version of what would be asked of you — and, just as importantly, of what would not.

— WHAT WE ASK —

1. **ONE FILM, OR MORE, WHEN READY.**

If you decide this is the place, we are inviting you to bring the work you'd want it to be defined by. That can be a film from XO Link's slate, a single piece from your direction work, or new work made on the AION Voice or volumetric-capture toolchains you've built. We are not chasing volume. We are honoring the standard your integrated practice already sets.

2. **PRODUCTION NOTES, WRITTEN BY YOU.**

A short director's statement for each film — what the film is, what it was trying to be, what the tools were, where the hand was, where the machine was. For someone working across volumetric capture, voice synthesis, and AI direction simultaneously, the production notes are not a chore. They are the record that lets a viewer take the work seriously, and the only register in which the technical decisions become legible alongside the cinematic ones.

3. **YOUR NAME ON THE FOUNDING WALL.**

A public credit as a founding filmmaker of DIONYSIA, with the right to revoke it at any time. The wall is the most visible asset in the platform's first year, and it belongs to the people who built the first chapter — permanently, regardless of where DIONYSIA goes after. XO Link's name appears beside yours if you'd like.

4. **PRESENCE, ON TWO NIGHTS.**

The Founding Filmmakers night — gated, private, peer-to-peer — and a single public premiere window in the weeks after, where you appear in the live room with viewers for thirty to forty-five minutes. Both are detailed in Section V, including how the London clock is accommodated.

5. **HONESTY, IN PRIVATE.**

Tell us what is broken. Tell us what is missing. Tell us when the editorial framing is wrong about your work — and tell us when a platform-level technical decision is one you'd make differently. The founding circle is a peerage, not a customer base. With your production-tech depth, that second register matters as much as the first.

— WHAT WE DO NOT ASK —

1. **NO EXCLUSIVITY REQUIRED.**

At this stage, no exclusivity is asked of you, on any film. Work from XO Link or anywhere else can keep distributing wherever you already place it. As the platform matures, opt-in premiere-window agreements with clear, transparent terms will be introduced — never as a default condition, and never tied to founding-circle status. The regulations that govern licensing, windowing, and rights will be written carefully and shared in writing before they take effect.

2. **NO VOLUME TARGETS, NO UPLOAD CADENCE.**

We will never ask you to ship faster. The founding circle exists in the opposite direction from those incentives. If you bring one film or you bring several, both are welcomed on the terms you set.

3. **NO MARKETING LABOR.**

You are not a growth channel for the platform. We will not ask you to repost, cross-promote, tag, or perform on social. If you choose to share through XO Link's channels or AION Voice's, that is yours.

4. **NO SILENCE IN EXCHANGE.**

If at any point this stops being a place you want your work in, you tell us, we lift the films, and you leave with everything you came with. The door swings both ways, at every size the platform reaches.

IV. SUBMISSION SPECIFICATIONS

The platform runs on a premium video pipeline (Mux), the same infrastructure used by MasterClass, Patreon, and HBO Max. The specs below will read as basic vocabulary — they are, deliberately, the language a volumetric-capture specialist running a production studio already speaks.

- **MASTER FORMAT** ProRes 422 HQ, DNxHR HQ, or high-bitrate H.264 / H.265 .mp4. Any high-quality master is fine; we transcode from there.
- **RESOLUTION** 1920×1080 minimum; 3840×2160 (4K) preferred where it exists. Vertical orientations supported but framed for letterbox display by default. Volumetric and light-field source material is welcomed but currently flattens to 2D delivery on the platform's player.
- **FRAME RATE** Native to your project — 23.976, 24, 25, or 29.97 fps. Do not conform unnecessarily.
- **AUDIO** Stereo or 5.1, 48 kHz, -14 LUFS integrated target (broadcast-streaming standard). Loudness pass strongly preferred; we can normalize if needed. AION Voice-generated tracks declared as such in provenance.
- **RUNTIME** No upper or lower bound. Shorts (under 15 minutes), features, episodic — the editorial frame adapts. We resist the dogma that any one runtime is "right" for the medium.
- **POSTER** A title-card still at 800×1200 (vertical) plus a 1920×1080 hero frame. If XO Link has existing key art, send what you already have.
- **CAPTIONS** .vtt or .srt in English. Machine-generated draft is fine; your final approval.
- **PROVENANCE** Tools used, hand-authored layers, AI-generated layers, volumetric-capture sources, voice synthesis tracks, and — if any synthesized likeness appears — performer-consent attestation. Part of the public film record. A moat, not a footnote.
- **DELIVERY** Direct link to a private cloud transfer (Frame.io, Dropbox, Google Drive, WeTransfer Pro). No public file hosts. Receipt confirmed in writing inside twenty-four hours.

These specifications are the current pipeline. The platform's video, audio, and rendering quality will continue to improve with every update — and masters delivered into the founding library automatically inherit every upgrade after. Volumetric and light-field native delivery is on the roadmap, not the current floor. The standard floor will only rise. Yours rises with it.

If any of the above is a problem — gear constraints, format mismatches, anything from XO Link's side — write back. The specs are a target, not a wall.

V. THE TWO NIGHTS

The first chapter has two scheduled moments. Both are deliberately curated. Both are non-negotiable as cinema events — they happen with their filmmakers, or they do not happen.

— THE FIRST NIGHT —

Founding Filmmakers, Sunday, May 24, 2026.

Private, gated, peer-only. The platform opens for the first time, with the founding filmmakers and the founder in the room. Magic-link sign-in, allowlist-only — no public URL works, no link forwards, no spillover. The work on the walls that night is the founding circle's. If you are in by then, your films are part of that catalog.

No press, no metrics, no audience-facing spectacle. The point of the first night is that the people who built the institution are the first to see it standing up.

— THE SECOND NIGHT —

DIONYSIA First Light, June 8–10, 2026 (one evening, date confirmed by June 1).

On the evening of June 8–10, we'll open the doors a little wider — for one night only. Film experts, curators, fellow artists, and the people you'd want in the room are invited to a live premiere of the founding work. You'll be the host, not the visitor. More on that closer to the date.

Live comment surface (Discord, Telegram, or Substack — locked by June 1). One founding film unveiled in full. The filmmaker present in the live room for thirty to forty-five minutes after the credits roll. Format borrowed from MUBI's "Film of the Night" and the indie album-release listening party, sharpened for cinema.

Your role on the second night, if you choose it, is not to perform. It is to be in the room while serious people watch your work for the first time, and to answer the questions that follow with the same care you put into making it.

London sits roughly five hours ahead of where the platform's launch coordinates fall. The founding circle is global by construction; the logistics flex around your clock. Your access on the first night opens at a time that works for London, and your live presence on the second night will be scheduled to a window that respects BST, not Toronto's evening.

VI. A DIRECT LINE

There is no support queue. There is no founding-creator portal. There is one person running this, and that person is reachable.

For anything substantive — film delivery, the editorial framing of your work, the second-night logistics, a doubt about the institution, an idea that should change the platform, a technical note about anything under the hood — write to kanishtuteja@gmail.com directly. Replies inside twenty-four hours, usually faster, time zones notwithstanding.

The platform itself lives at dionysia.ca. Until May 24 it shows a single opening surface. On the first night, the room behind it opens, and your allowlisted email gets you in.

If something is wrong, say it directly. The founding circle is small enough — and serious enough — that there is no professional reason to soften the signal. You're not a customer. You're a peer being asked to evaluate a peerage before deciding to join it.

VII. CLOSING

The cultural surfaces that defined the last century of cinema — the studios, the festivals, the houses — all began with a founding circle of artists who took the work seriously before anyone was watching.

DIONYSIA is being built to be one of those surfaces for the medium that comes next: to be everywhere this work deserves to be seen, on every screen it deserves to live on, for as long as cinema is made this way. If you decide this is the place, the institution begins with you in it.

The reel is hand-set, frame by frame. Thank you for the headline that stopped the scroll.

— ONE LAST WORD, JUST FOR YOU —

Toby, the rare thing in your profile is not any single credential. It is the integration. Filmmaker plus Michelin-Star Data Chef plus AI Creative plus CEO of XO Link plus co-founder of AION Voice plus volumetric-capture specialist is not a stack of jobs. It is one craft expressed across the layers most filmmakers in this medium have not yet realized are the same layers — vision, voice, capture, direction, all running on the same discipline imported from somewhere outside the AI scene's usual training. The founding circle gets, in you, that integration on the wall.

London matters as well. With Paris (Brice Weber, TOUKI, HOPE) already in and Montreal (Luc Leclerc, Above The Void) in too, adding the British-Anglophone European anchor gives DIONYSIA its first proper London–Paris–Montreal triangle from day one — three of the cities the next chapter of this medium has to run through. Having you on the London end of it would change the geography of what the platform looks like at first light.

Whatever the work you'd want this place to be defined by — XO Link's slate, AION Voice-driven pieces, anything volumetric — bring it. Whatever needs to flex around your CEO calendar, the studio's roadmap, or the rhythm of building two ventures simultaneously — say it. The room is being built with that conversation already in mind.

Welcome in, if you choose to be.

— *Kanish*

FOUNDER, DIONYSIA
DIONYSIA.CA